PEW RESEARCH CENTER
NOVEMBER 17-20, 2011 OMNIBUS
FINAL TOPLINE
N=1,003

ASK ALL:

PEW.1 As I read a list of some stories covered by news organizations this past week, please tell me if you happened to follow each news story very closely, fairly closely, not too closely, or not at all closely. First, **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE;] [IF NECESSARY** "Did you follow **[ITEM]** very closely, fairly closely, not too closely or not at all closely?"**]**

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
a. A sex abuse scandal at Penn State University					
November 17-20, 2011	28	31	21	18	1
November 10-13, 2011: *A sex abuse scandal at Penn State University resulting in the firing of the school's president and football coach Joe Paterno*	34	29	19	18	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
August 18-21, 2011: *Recent scandals in college football*	10	12	17	61	*
September 16-19, 2010: *Pope Benedict's visit to Great Britain and his comments on the Catholic Church's handling of sex-abuse scandals*	10	16	26	47	1
April 23-26, 2010: *Reports about the Vatican's handling of sex-abuse scandals in the Catholic Church*	14	28	29	29	*
March 26-29, 2010	17	24	28	30	*
March 19-22, 2010	8	18	31	42	1
June, 2002: *Reports of sexual abuses by Catholic priests*	38	36	17	8	1
May, 2002: *The Pope and American cardinals meeting in Rome about sexual abuse by Catholic priests*	27	33	21	18	1
Early April, 2002: *Reports of sexual abuses by Catholic priests*	27	34	25	13	1
December, 1993	18	32	31	18	1
b. A congressional "super committee" that has until November 23rd to propose a deficit reduction plan					
November 17-20, 2011	17	24	22	36	1
November 10-13, 2011: *A congressional "super committee" whose goal is to significantly reduce the federal budget deficit*	19	21	24	36	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
November 3-6, 2011: *Discussions in Washington about how to address the federal budget deficit and national debt*	24	31	21	24	1
October 27-30, 2011	25	28	21	25	1
October 13-16, 2011: *The debate in Washington over jobs and the deficit*	29	32	15	24	1
September 29-October 2, 2011: *Congress working on a budget extension to avoid a government shutdown*	31	26	20	22	*
September 22-25, 2011: *The debate in Washington over jobs and the deficit*	35	26	19	19	1

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
September 15-18, 2011: *The debate in Washington over President Obama's jobs legislation*	31	28	19	21	2
September 8-11, 2011: *Barack Obama's speech about jobs to a joint session of Congress*	28	18	17	36	1
August 4-7, 2011: *Congress and the President agreeing to cut federal spending and raise the debt limit*	46	25	13	14	1
July 28-31, 2011: *Discussions in Washington about how to address the federal budget deficit and national debt*	41	27	15	17	*
July 21-24, 2011	38	28	17	17	*
July 14-17, 2011	34	29	18	19	*
June 16-19, 2011: *Debate in Washington over whether to raise the federal debt limit*	24	26	22	28	*
June 2-5, 2011	23	24	22	31	*
May 26-29, 2011: *Discussions in Washington about how to address the federal budget deficit*	25	26	20	29	*
May 12-15, 2011	21	26	24	28	1
May 5-8, 2011: *Discussions in Washington about how to address the federal budget deficit and national debt*	29	28	22	20	1
April 21-25, 2011	30	31	18	21	*
April 14-17, 2011	36	27	18	19	1
April 7-10, 2011: *The threat of a government shutdown because of budget disagreements in Washington*	47	26	15	12	*
March 31-April 3, 2011: *Discussions in Washington about how to address the federal budget deficit*	30	27	21	22	*
March 17-20, 2011	24	25	24	26	1
March 3-6, 2011	26	29	19	26	1
February 17-20, 2011	27	30	17	25	1
December 2-5, 2010	35	25	21	17	2
December 2-5, 2010: *The debate in Washington over the federal income tax cuts passed when George W. Bush was president*	39	26	17	17	1
November 11-14, 2010: *Proposals made by leaders of the federal budget deficit commission*	15	21	21	41	1
September 16-19, 2010: *The debate in Washington over competing Democratic and Republican tax plans*	21	24	21	34	*
September 9-12, 2010	16	19	22	42	1
May 8-11, 2009: *The debate in Washington over the federal budget*	22	28	19	31	*
March 27-30, 2009: *Debate over Barack Obama's budget proposal*	28	34	18	19	1
March 6-9, 2009: *Obama proposing a $630 billion fund for overhauling health care*	41	32	13	14	*
February 27-March 2, 2009: *Barack Obama's budget proposal for next year that raises taxes on wealthy Americans and increases spending on health care, education and other programs*	47	34	9	10	*

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
February 27-March 2, 2009: *The Obama administration's plan to help homeowners facing foreclosure which could cost as much as $275 billion dollars*	31	36	19	13	1
February 20-23, 2009: *The $780 billion economic stimulus legislation approved by Congress and signed into law by President Obama*	41	37	14	8	*
February 13-16, 2009: *Congress passing Barack Obama's economic stimulus plan*	50	32	13	5	*
February 6-9, 2009: *The debate in Congress over Barack Obama's economic stimulus plan*	41	33	15	11	*
January 30-February 2, 2009	36	29	22	13	*
January 16-19, 2009: *Debate in Washington over what the government should do about the nation's economic problems*	35	33	17	15	*
January 9-12, 2009: *Projections of a record high federal budget deficit this year*	35	30	19	16	*
December 19-22, 2008: *The Bush administration's plan to provide billions in emergency loans to U.S. automakers*	37	33	16	13	1
December 12-15, 2008: *The debate over a government bailout for the U.S. auto industry*	40	33	18	9	*
December 5-8, 2008: *The debate in Congress over a government bailout for the U.S. auto industry*	34	38	17	11	*
November 21-24, 2008	41	26	17	15	1
October 3-6, 2008: *The debate in Washington over a plan to use government funds to stabilize financial markets*	62	26	7	5	*
September 26-29, 2008	60	22	10	8	*
September 12-15, 2008: *The federal government taking control of the mortgage companies Fannie Mae and Freddie Mac*	28	35	19	17	1
March 20-24, 2008: *The buyout of Wall Street investment bank Bear Stearns*	21	26	21	32	*
February 8-11, 2008: *President Bush and Congress agreeing on an economic Stimulus plan*	22	33	23	21	1
January 25-28, 2008	24	36	19	21	*
February, 2003: *George W. Bush's tax cut and economic stimulus plan*	26	33	23	16	2
February, 2003	26	33	23	16	2
January, 2003	28	34	21	15	2
February, 2002: *The debate in Congress over George W. Bush's budget and tax cut plan*	17	31	28	23	1
April, 2001	24	38	20	18	*
February, 2001: *George W. Bush's tax cut plan*	31	35	19	14	1
August, 1997: *The debate in Washington about the federal budget*	14	34	25	26	1
May, 1997	16	38	23	22	1
February, 1997	19	28	22	29	2
March, 1996	24	35	23	18	*
January, 1996	32	42	17	9	*

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
September, 1995	20	35	27	18	*
August, 1995: *The debate in Congress over the federal budget*	18	34	27	20	1
February, 1995: *The debate in Congress over the Balanced Budget Amendment*	12	31	28	28	1
August, 1993: The debate in Congress over Bill Clinton's budget bill	30	36	21	13	*
June, 1993	12	38	31	18	1
February, 1993: *Bill Clinton's economic plan*	49	36	10	5	*
September, 1992 *(RV)*: *George Bush's plan to improve the economy by cutting government spending and cutting taxes*	28	44	18	9	1
November, 1990: *Congressional and administration efforts to reach a budget deficit agreement*	34	33	20	11	2
October, 1990: *Attempts by Congress and the administration to find ways to reduce the budget deficit*	34	37	17	12	*
August, 1989: *Passage of a bill to bailout ailing savings and loan institutions*	26	30	20	23	1
c. Anti-Wall Street protests in several cities around the country					
November 17-20, 2011	20	30	24	25	1
November 10-13, 2011	16	30	24	29	1
November 3-6, 2011	18	29	22	30	1
October 27-30, 2011: *Anti-Wall Street protests in New York and other cities*	19	27	23	31	1
October 20-23, 2011	19	29	20	31	1
October 13-16, 2011	22	31	21	26	1
October 6-9, 2011	17	25	22	35	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
March 10-13, 2011: *Disputes in Wisconsin and other states between state governments and public employee unions*	30	26	18	25	1
March 3-6, 2011	29	24	19	27	1
February 24-27, 2011	36	22	15	26	1
April 16-19, 2010: *Anti-government protests on April 15*	16	21	21	41	1
April 17-20, 2009: *Tea party protests against taxes and government spending*	27	25	22	25	1
May, 2000: *The protests in Washington, D.C., at the annual meetings of the World Bank and International Monetary Fund*	6	18	32	43	1
December, 1999: *The protests in Seattle at the World Trade Organization meeting*	18	30	27	24	1
d. The U.S. Supreme Court agreeing to hear legal challenges to last year's health care reform law					
November 17-20, 2011	18	24	24	33	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
February 3-6, 2011: *A federal judge ruling that part of the new health care law is unconstitutional*	25	28	19	28	1
January 20-23, 2011: *News about Republican efforts to repeal last year's health care law*	29	29	20	21	1

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
December 16-19, 2010: *A federal judge ruling that parts of the new health care law are unconstitutional*	28	24	17	30	1
September 23-26, 2010: *News about portions of this year's health care reform law beginning to take effect*	37	31	17	14	1
April 16-19, 2010: *News about the new health care reform law*	40	30	16	14	*
April 9-12, 2010	46	27	15	12	*
April 1-5, 2010	42	27	14	16	*
March 26-29, 2010: *Debate over health care reform*	49	29	12	10	*
March 19-22, 2010	51	24	11	14	*
March 12-15, 2010	40	31	16	13	*
March 5-8, 2010	42	27	17	15	*
February 26-March 1, 2010	29	29	19	22	*
February 19-22, 2010	33	28	19	19	*
January 29-February 1, 2010	39	27	16	17	*
January 22-25, 2010	41	32	15	11	*
January 15-18, 2010	37	27	19	18	*
January 8-11, 2010	39	26	20	15	*
December 18-21, 2009	42	27	16	14	*
December 11-14, 2009	42	30	15	14	*
December 4-7, 2009	42	28	15	14	1
November 20-23, 2009	42	29	14	15	*
November 13-16, 2009	38	26	17	17	1
November 6-9, 2009	35	28	15	22	1
October 30-November 2, 2009	32	26	19	23	*
October 23-26, 2009	40	27	16	17	1
October 16-19, 2009	36	28	15	21	*
October 9-12, 2009	37	29	14	19	1
October 2-5, 2009	39	29	16	16	*
September 25-28, 2009	45	31	12	12	0
September 18-21, 2009	44	26	19	11	*
September 11-14, 2009	44	27	14	15	*
September 3-6, 2009	40	26	16	17	0
August 28-31, 2009	40	28	17	14	1
August 21-24, 2009	49	24	12	15	1
August 14-17, 2009	39	31	15	15	1
August 7-10, 2009: *Debate in Washington over health care reform*	40	27	17	15	1
July 31-August 3, 2009	47	26	14	13	1
July 24-27, 2009	44	28	15	13	*
July 17-20, 2009	33	31	13	21	2
July 10-13, 2009	24	29	20	27	*
June 26-29, 2009	29	26	20	25	1
June 19-22, 2009	28	28	20	23	*
June 12-15, 2009	29	26	18	26	*
May 15-18, 2009: *Debate over Barack Obama's health care plans*	25	30	20	24	*
March 6-9, 2009: *Obama proposing a $630 billion fund for overhauling health care*	41	32	13	14	*
e. News about candidates for the 2012 presidential elections					
November 17-20, 2011	24	31	21	23	1
November 3-6, 2011	22	31	20	26	1
October 27-30, 2011	21	26	21	30	1
October 20-23, 2011	21	28	22	28	1

PEW.1 CONTINUED...

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	(VOL.) DK/Ref
October 13-16, 2011	26	29	22	23	1
October 6-9, 2011	25	25	23	27	1
September 29-October 2, 2011	27	26	21	25	*
September 22-25, 2011	25	26	23	25	1
September 15-18, 2011	24	28	21	27	1
September 8-11, 2011	22	26	21	31	*
September 1-4, 2011	22	23	22	32	1
August 25-28, 2011	22	22	22	33	1
August 18-21, 2011	27	26	19	28	1
August 11-14, 2011	19	24	20	36	1
August 4-7, 2011	18	21	22	37	1
July 28-31, 2011	17	27	21	35	1
July 21-24, 2011	17	22	28	32	*
July 14-17, 2011	18	26	27	28	1
July 7-10, 2011	16	23	27	33	1
June 30-July 3, 2011	21	28	24	25	2
June 23-26, 2011	19	26	24	31	*
June 16-19, 2011	23	29	23	25	*
June 9-12, 2011	18	30	22	30	1
June 2-5, 2011	21	31	22	26	*
May 26-29, 2011	20	27	24	28	*
May 19-22, 2011	15	27	24	32	1
May 12-15, 2011	15	22	26	35	1
May 5-8, 2011	16	24	27	32	1
April 21-25, 2011	18	26	23	32	1
April 14-17, 2011	20	23	29	27	1
March 24-27, 2011	13	19	26	41	1
March 10-13, 2011	15	21	26	38	0
February 10-13, 2011	16	19	24	40	*
February 3-6, 2011	15	20	23	42	*
SEE TRENDS FOR PREVIOUS YEARS					
f. Reports about the condition of the U.S. economy					
November 17-20, 2011	35	33	16	15	1
November 10-13, 2011	39	31	15	14	*
November 3-6, 2011	37	31	15	17	1
October 27-30, 2011	38	33	14	15	1
October 20-23, 2011	38	32	14	16	1
October 13-16, 2011	39	32	14	14	*
October 6-9, 2011	43	28	14	14	1
September 29-October 2, 2011	46	26	14	14	*
September 22-25, 2011	44	33	11	11	*
September 8-11, 2011	40	30	15	14	1
September 1-4, 2011	44	30	11	15	*
August 25-28, 2011	44	28	14	13	1
August 18-21, 2011	44	29	12	14	1
August 4-7, 2011	46	30	11	13	1
July 28-31, 2011	43	30	13	13	*
July 21-24, 2011	41	32	13	13	1
July 14-17, 2011	41	30	14	14	1
July 7-10, 2011	36	30	15	18	1
June 30-July 3, 2011	38	32	13	16	1
June 23-26, 2011	37	29	15	19	*
June 16-19, 2011	39	33	14	13	*
June 9-12, 2011	39	30	15	16	1
June 2-5, 2011	35	34	17	14	*
May 19-22, 2011	33	34	17	16	*
May 12-15, 2011	32	32	17	18	2

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
May 5-8, 2011	40	35	15	9	1
April 21-25, 2011	41	33	12	14	*
April 14-17, 2011	44	30	14	12	1
April 7-10, 2011	46	30	14	10	*
March 31-April 3, 2011	42	31	16	11	0
March 24-27, 2011	36	32	17	15	*
March 17-20, 2011	38	32	17	13	*
March 10-13, 2011	40	30	16	13	*
March 3-6, 2011	37	31	17	13	1
February 24-27, 2011	49	29	11	10	*
February 17-20, 2011	35	33	14	17	*
February 10-13, 2011	36	34	13	16	*
February 3-6, 2011	35	37	14	14	*
January 20-23, 2011	37	33	14	15	1
January 13-16, 2011	37	29	15	18	1
January 6-9, 2011	39	37	11	12	1

SEE TRENDS FOR PREVIOUS YEARS

ASK ALL:

PEW.2 Which ONE of the stories I just mentioned have you followed most closely, or is there another story you've been following MORE closely? [**DO NOT READ LIST. ACCEPT ONLY ONE RESPONSE.]**

Nov 17-20 2011	
27	A sex abuse scandal at Penn State University
15	Reports about the condition of the U.S. economy
13	News about candidates for the 2012 presidential elections
9	Anti-Wall Street protests in several cities around the country
5	The U.S. Supreme Court agreeing to hear legal challenges to last year's health care reform law
3	A congressional "super committee" that has until November 23rd to propose a deficit reduction plan
9	Some other story **(VOL.)**
19	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**